

HOUSE BILL 2089

By Powers

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 15;
Title 49, Chapter 1 and Title 49, Chapter 6, relative
to victims of communism.

WHEREAS, over 100 years have passed since the Bolshevik Revolution in Russia and the formation of the first communist government under Vladimir Lenin, which led to decades of oppression and violence under communist regimes throughout the world; and

WHEREAS, based on the economic philosophies of Karl Marx, communism has proven incompatible with the ideals of liberty, prosperity, and dignity of human life; and

WHEREAS, communism has given rise to infamous totalitarian dictators, including Joseph Stalin, Vladimir Lenin, Mao Zedong, and Pol Pot; and

WHEREAS, communist regimes worldwide have killed more than 100 million people and subjected countless others to exploitation and unspeakable atrocities, with victims representing many different ethnicities, creeds, and backgrounds; and

WHEREAS, communist regimes have systematically robbed their own citizens of the rights of freedom of worship, freedom of speech, and freedom of association through false promises of equality and liberation or through coercion, brutality, and fear; and

WHEREAS, regimes persecuted those who spoke out in opposition and held many victims of communism as political prisoners, while others were killed in genocidal, state-sponsored purges of undesirable groups; and

WHEREAS, in addition to violating basic human rights, communist regimes have suppressed intellectual freedom, cultural life, and self-determination movements in more than forty nations; now, therefore,

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49, Chapter 6, Part 10, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

(a) November 7 of each year, LEAs and public charter schools shall recognize the day as "Victims of Communism Day" to honor victims of communist regimes.

(b) If an LEA or public charter school provides a world history and geography course to high school students enrolled in an LEA or public charter school, then the LEA or public charter school shall provide the students enrolled in the course with at least forty-five (45) minutes of instruction on how victims suffered under communist regimes, including through poverty, starvation, migration, systemized lethal violence, and suppression of speech, in conjunction with any of the following topics:

- (1) Mao Zedong and the Cultural Revolution;
- (2) Joseph Stalin and the Soviet System;
- (3) Fidel Castro and the Cuban Revolution;
- (4) Pol Pot and the Khmer Rouge; or
- (5) Nicolás Maduro and the Chavismo movement.

(c) If Victims of Communism Day is on a day that a high school student who is enrolled in a world history and geography course does not receive instruction for the course, then the student must receive the instruction required by this section on the next day that the student receives instruction for the course.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it, and applies to the 2026-2027 school year and subsequent school years.